

Michael J. West

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Engineering lead with 8+ years building consumer web and mobile products and growing the teams behind them.

Engineering is a team sport. I lead without ego, mentor without gatekeeping, and I get more satisfaction watching a junior engineer nail something independently than I do shipping something myself. For me, a great team is the product.

EXPERIENCE

Senior Frontend Developer, Tactacam LLC (2022 - 2026)

- Promoted from engineer to lead developer on FeatherSnap, scaling the platform from MVP to 50k MAU in ~2 years
- Owned technical and people leadership for a team of up to 5 onshore and offshore engineers across FeatherSnap and Defend Security Cameras
- Owned onboarding for all new team members, including onshore, offshore, and interns; led a summer internship program that grew two junior engineers into mid- and senior-level contributors through structured 1:1s, paired code review, and growth-oriented goal-setting
- Partnered with marketing, design, and product as the engineering lead on requirements gathering, scope refinement, and adjacent-system alignment, translating business needs into technical solutions
- Ran sprint planning, ticket grooming, and delivery tracking in Jira, tuning the workflow to match release cadence; hit every committed deadline across the team's tenure and proactively communicated with stakeholders on the rare occasions a date needed to move
- Set sprint goals, delegated workstreams, and managed effort estimation across the team to keep releases on schedule as scope expanded across two product lines
- Deployed team-level process improvements, owning CI/CD and release automation (~3x release frequency) and championing LLM-assisted code review, test generation, and refactoring (~50% reduction in review cycle time); shared outcomes with other teams
- Drove frontend architecture and tooling decisions across React Native and Next.js for the team; contributed to backend serverless infrastructure (AWS CDK, API Gateway, Lambda, DynamoDB) to reduce the team's dependency on adjacent backend engineers
- Delivered consumer monetization features through team execution, including a social feed, onboarding and payment flows, and e-commerce shops that generated \$2,000+ in revenue in the first week after launch

ADDITIONAL EXPERIENCE

Frontend Software Engineer, Society of Automotive Engineers (SAE) (2021)

- Built complex multi-step onboarding flows in Angular for DATC, a core growth product generating millions in annual revenue, featuring conditional logic, dynamic validation, and form state management across multiple screens
- Contributed to effort estimation and formal Agile ceremonies (sprint planning, stand-ups, retrospectives, reviews) within a Scrum team

Software Engineer I/DevOps Engineer, DDI (2019-2020)

- Automated CI/CD workflows with Azure DevOps, reducing deployment overhead across the team; coordinated weekly deployments across the company's product suite
- Built data visualization and course content features across React Native, Angular, D3, and .NET

Programmer/Analyst, Federated Investors (2017-2018)

- Delivered a proof-of-concept scheduling tool in 3 weeks within a regulated financial enterprise, securing executive approval to replace a legacy system with a full rebuild
- Resolved production data integrity issues across millions of records by updating SQL stored procedures and batch scripts in a regulated financial environment

SKILLS & TECHNOLOGIES

- Leadership & Process: Team mentorship, Agile/Scrum, code review practice, CI/CD ownership, effort estimation, technical hiring input
- Languages: JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL, C#
- Frameworks & Platforms: React, React Native, Next.js, Angular, Node.js
- Cloud & DevOps: AWS (CDK, Lambda, API Gateway, DynamoDB, S3, SNS), GitHub Actions, Azure DevOps, Expo EAS
- Testing & Monitoring: Jest, React Testing Library, Sentry
- Analytics: Google Analytics, Survicate

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Science, Computer Engineering, University of Pittsburgh

Minor: Industrial Engineering (process optimization, engineering management, human factors engineering)